Lesson 11: Timers, Difficulty and Game Over

Module 4 | 45 minutes | Time and difficulty | Grades 6–8 · ages 11–14

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise what you learned today. Read each task carefully.

1. Key words

Match each word to what it means. Write the letter.

a. countdown ___ A. The end state of a game.
b. difficulty curve ___ B. How a game gets harder over time.
c. game over ___ C. A variable that goes down to zero.

2. Plan your code

Before you build it: Countdown: when the flag is clicked, set time to 5. Repeat 5 times: wait 1 second and change time by -1. Then say “Time’s up!”. Write or draw the blocks you will use.

3. Plan your code

Before you build it: Difficulty ramp: speed starts at 2. A forever loop waits 1 second and changes speed by 1. The Rock falls with change y by (0 - speed), so it gets faster. Write or draw the blocks you will use.

4. Shape the challenge

Order a fair game from start to finish Number them 1–5.

a. ___ Lives or time run out
b. ___ Increase speed gradually
c. ___ Start slow so players learn the controls
d. ___ Reset score, lives, speed and timer
e. ___ Show the final score and stop all

5. Explain your thinking

How would you make your game fair but challenging? Describe your starting difficulty, how it ramps up and how the game ends.

How did it go? Colour a face: 😀 I can do it · 🙂 Nearly there · 🤔 I need help

☐ I can make a countdown or time limit.
☐ I can increase difficulty with a variable.
☐ I can end a game clearly.